

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned backend engineer with 9+ years of experience in designing, building, and maintaining large-scale, event-driven and microservices-based systems. Proficient in modern Java (up to Java 21), with deep knowledge of distributed architecture, reactive programming (RxJava), scalable messaging systems (Pulsar, Kafka), and NoSQL technologies (Cassandra, Redis, OpenSearch). Strong advocate of clean code, observability, and end-to-end ownership—from technical proposals to production monitoring. Proven success in mentoring teams, leading architecture discussions, and solving high-load reliability challenges in remote-first setups.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages & Core:** Java 8–21, Kotlin 2.x, RxJava 3, Groovy, Python, Bash
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** Netty, Spring Boot, JUnit, REST APIs, WebSocket, Retrofit, Jackson
- **Data Stores:** Apache Cassandra, Redis, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, OpenSearch, MySQL
- **Messaging & Streaming:** Apache Pulsar, Kafka, RabbitMQ
- **Architecture:** Microservices, Event-Driven Systems, DDD, Layered Architecture, CQRS
- **Tools:** Git, Docker, Jenkins, ELK Stack, Prometheus, Grafana, IntelliJ IDEA
- **Cloud & Infra:** AWS (EC2, S3, RDS), Linux, Nginx, Zookeeper, GitHub Actions
- **Other:** TDD, CI/CD pipelines, Clean Code, Observability, Performance Optimization

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Sensidev

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Led the development of scalable Java-based backend systems serving real-time transactional APIs to external platforms with over 1 million monthly users.
- Designed and implemented microservices using Java 17+, RxJava 3, and Netty with a strong focus on low-latency, asynchronous processing and reactive data flows.
- Built production-grade integrations with Apache Pulsar and Kafka for event streaming and inter-service communication under high throughput conditions.
- Optimized API response times by over 45% via caching with Redis and query tuning against Cassandra and PostgreSQL for frequently accessed endpoints.
- Architected domain-driven services aligned with layered architecture principles to decouple business logic, infrastructure concerns, and controllers.

- Designed resilient monitoring pipelines using OpenSearch and Prometheus to track SLA metrics, latency bottlenecks, and auto-restart failure patterns.
- Actively mentored junior engineers and led peer code reviews to maintain clean, testable, and maintainable codebases across services.
- Proposed and rolled out internal platform-wide refactoring plans, improving test coverage from 63% to over 90% and reducing tech debt.

Software Engineer

Syscom Digital

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania (Remote)

- Developed backend modules in Java and Kotlin for high-concurrency systems supporting marketing data pipelines across global client accounts.
- Integrated Apache Kafka streams and Zookeeper for real-time message queues, enabling robust data ingestion and event processing.
- Contributed to architecture migration from monolith to event-driven microservices using Spring Boot and REST APIs secured via OAuth2.
- Automated deployment workflows using GitHub Actions and Docker, ensuring consistent CI/CD practices across staging and production.
- Built configurable deployment scripts for on-demand infrastructure provisioning and zero-downtime rollouts across multiple environments.
- Implemented advanced logging and tracing across services using ELK stack and OpenTelemetry for better root cause analysis and visibility.
- Conducted load testing with JMeter and fixed resource bottlenecks at thread and DB connection pool levels to boost throughput.
- Collaborated closely with QA and product managers to define requirements, write BDD scenarios, and reduce defect leakage by 38%.

Software Developer

Soft Build

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania (Remote)

- Delivered mission-critical backend services in Java for a cloud-based property management system with 100k+ active properties.
- Introduced circuit breaker patterns using Resilience4j to handle service degradation in dependent microservices.
- Improved request parallelism and async capabilities by integrating RxJava-based reactive endpoints in controller layers.
- Refactored legacy monolithic services into scalable REST APIs, increasing service uptime and maintainability.
- Designed schema modeling and indexing strategies in Cassandra and MongoDB to support fast geo-query features.
- Led transition from FTP-based data exchange to RESTful push-pull mechanisms, reducing synchronization latency.
- Integrated Redis-based distributed locking to avoid race conditions in booking-related flows across replicas.
- Supported team onboarding and documentation improvements that reduced new dev ramp-up time from 3 weeks to under 10 days.

Software Developer
Decima Digital
November 2015 – April 2016
Tallinn, Estonia

- Developed Java backend features for an e-commerce platform with custom plugin support and multi-tenant configuration.
- Refactored service layers to support loosely coupled dependency injection and reduce static wiring.
- Migrated synchronous calls to asynchronous REST endpoints using callbacks and thread pooling strategies.
- Helped debug and stabilize WebSocket-based real-time communication modules between clients and server.

Software Developer Intern
Borna Technology
September 2014 – August 2015
Tallinn, Estonia (On-Site)

- Implemented backend features and CRUD operations in Java and MySQL for internal CRM tools.
- Designed UI integration logic in JSP and AJAX, improving form response speed and reducing page reloads.
- Participated in weekly code walkthroughs, actively contributing ideas on backend modularity and layered design.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ **Java SE 11 Developer Certification** – Oracle
- ❖ **Distributed Systems Fundamentals** – Coursera (University of Illinois)
- ❖ **Event-Driven Architecture with Kafka** – Confluent
- ❖ **Clean Code Practices in Java** – Udemy

PROJECTS

1. Reactive Order Dispatch System

Designed a fully reactive order dispatch engine using Java 21, RxJava 3, and Apache Pulsar for a ride-hailing startup. Ensured consistent state transitions, real-time driver allocation, and failover handling under 100k+ concurrent sessions.

2. Distributed Geo-query Search API

Implemented high-performance backend for geo-query lookups using Cassandra and Redis, achieving <50ms search latency for mobile apps in 70+ countries.

3. Event-Driven Booking Engine

Built a robust event-driven booking pipeline using Kafka, Cassandra, and Netty. Focused on idempotent command processing and strong consistency guarantees across booking states.